

Loosen the chokehold on our city roads

India's roads badly need to be **decongested**. While **hurrahing urbanisation** and **upward mobility** is all very fine, **clogged** roads is a problem that if not tackled now, will **snowball** into a far bigger urban issue affecting quality of life and ease of going places to the point of no return. But we need a **rational**, effective plan that can be **retrofitted** according to the city, not **pell-mell** action. Take the Municipal Corporation of Delhi's proposal to hike parking charges. This is about increasing revenues, not tackling **congestion**. The rates are linked to the **neighbourhood's** land value and **infrastructure**, the principle being the rich should pay more. Fair enough. But even as a proportion may use **ride-hailing services** in these areas, with the demand for parking **inelastic**, they will simply pay more.

Tackling **congestion** requires moving on several **fronts** simultaneously - improving the quality and **quantum** of public transport, **upping** parking charges, and improved infrastructure for non-motorised vehicles. Delhi's vehicle population has risen by about 30% a year, while public parking sites remain relatively **stagnant** at 420. **Progressive** parking charges can help - higher rates for locations with high traffic inflow and parking demand, **differential parking rates reflecting** peak and off-peak hours, and **efficient** and smart parking solutions to **optimise existing** spaces.



Consumers also need **amenable** alternatives **to** private transport. Progressive countries have their car-owning population, the **well-heeled** included, who also opt for public transport, using their cars for special **outings**, weekends, road trips, etc. There is no **silver bullet** to decongesting. But **encouraging** car-users to avoid **reaching out** for their car keys for any purpose **is** where the answer lies.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

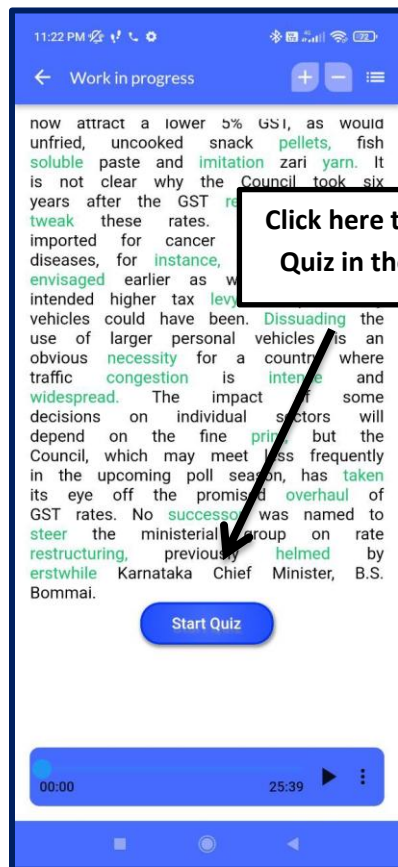
1. **Loosen** (verb) – Relax, slacken, ease, release, reduce ढीला करना या उन्नत भागों को जोड़ना या संशोधित करना।
2. **Chokehold** (noun) – Stranglehold, grip, control, constriction, domination दबाव
3. **Decongest** (verb) – Unclog, clear, free up, alleviate, reduce भीड़ कम करना
4. **Hurrah** (verb) – Cheer, applaud, celebrate, acclaim, laud जयकार करना
5. **Urbanisation** (noun) – City development, metropolitan growth, urban growth, city expansion, urban sprawl नगरीकरण
6. **Upward mobility** (noun) – movement or the ability to move to a higher social class सामाजिक उन्नति
7. **Clogged** (adjective) – Blocked, congested, jammed, choked, obstructed जाम हुई
8. **Snowball** (verb) – Escalate, intensify, increase, grow, expand बढ़ना
9. **Rational** (adjective) – Logical, reasonable, sensible, coherent, sound तर्कसंगत
10. **Retrofit** (verb) – To add a component or accessory to something that did not have it when it was manufactured, or to modify something with new or updated parts. पुराने उपकरणों या प्रणालियों में नए
11. **Pell-mell** (adjective) – Haphazard, chaotic, disorderly, random, unplanned अव्यवस्थित
12. **Congestion** (noun) – Overcrowding, blockage, traffic jam, bottleneck, gridlock भीड़
13. **Neighbourhood** (noun) – Community, district, area, locality, vicinity पड़ोस
14. **Infrastructure** (noun) – Facilities, systems, structures, framework, amenities अवसंरचना
15. **Ride-hailing service** (noun) – Taxi service, cab service, transportation service, car hire service, on-demand ride service सवारी सेवा
16. **Inelastic** (adjective) – not changing much, or not allowing much change: स्थिर
17. **Front** (noun) – Area, aspect, dimension, field, sector पहलू
18. **Quantum** (noun) – Amount, quantity, measure, portion, volume मात्रा
19. **Up** (verb) – Increase, raise, boost, elevate, enhance बढ़ाना

20. **Stagnant** (adjective) – Inactive, still, static, immobile, unchanging स्थिर
21. **Progressive** (adjective) – Forward-looking, advanced, modern, innovative, reformist प्रगतिशील
22. **Differential parking rate** (noun) – Variable parking fee
23. **Reflect** (verb) – Indicate, show, display, represent, mirror दिखाना
24. **Efficient** (adjective) – Effective, proficient, competent, productive, streamlined कुशल
25. **Optimise** (verb) – Maximize, enhance, improve, make the most of, perfect अनुकूलित करना
26. **Existing** (adjective) – Current, present, in place, established, available मौजूदा
27. **Amenable** (to) (adjective) – Open, receptive, responsive, agreeable, compliant अनुकूल
28. **Well-heeled** (adjective) – Wealthy, affluent, rich, prosperous, well-off धनी
29. **Outing** (noun) – Excursion, trip, jaunt, excursion, adventure यात्रा
30. **Silver bullet** (phrase) – a quick solution to a difficult problem
31. **Reach out** (phrasal verb) – Extend, offer, contact, communicate, approach पहुँचना

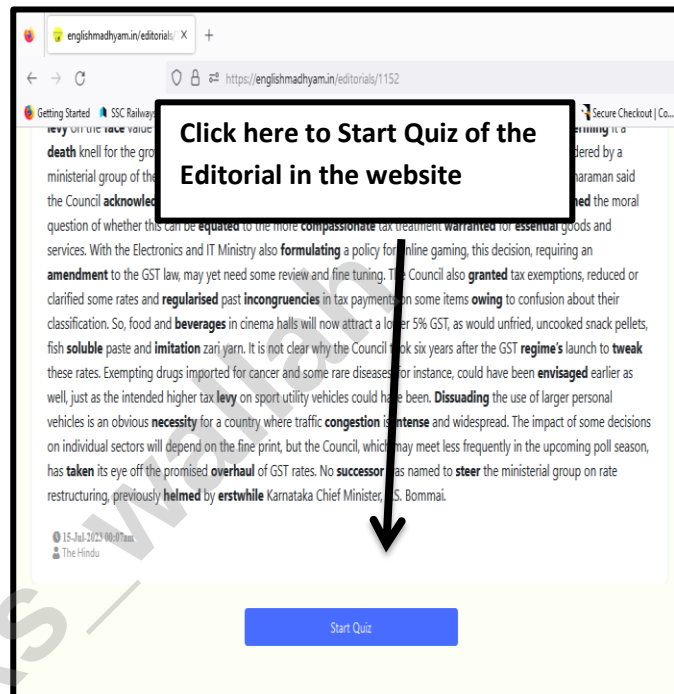
Summary of the Editorial

1. Urgency of Decongestion: India's roads need immediate decongestion to prevent a larger urban crisis affecting quality of life and mobility.
2. Urbanisation Issues: Celebrating urbanisation and upward mobility is good, but the resulting clogged roads are problematic.
3. Need for Effective Plans: A rational, effective plan tailored to each city is necessary instead of haphazard actions.
4. Parking Charges Proposal: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi's proposal to hike parking charges aims to increase revenue, not solve congestion.
5. Wealth-Based Charges: Parking charges are linked to the neighbourhood's land value, with higher rates for richer areas.
6. Inelastic Parking Demand: Despite higher charges, demand for parking remains inelastic as people will simply pay more.
7. Multifaceted Approach Needed: Tackling congestion requires improvements in public transport, parking charges, and infrastructure for non-motorised vehicles.
8. Vehicle Population Growth: Delhi's vehicle population increases by about 30% annually, while public parking sites remain stagnant.
9. Progressive Parking Charges: Higher parking rates in high-traffic areas, differential rates for peak/off-peak hours, and smart parking solutions can help.
10. Need for Alternatives: Consumers need viable alternatives to private transport to reduce reliance on personal vehicles.
11. Global Examples: Progressive countries have car owners, including the affluent, who use public transport regularly, reserving cars for special occasions.
12. No Single Solution: There is no single solution to decongestion; multiple strategies are necessary.
13. Encouraging Public Transport: Encouraging car users to prefer public transport over personal cars is crucial.
14. Infrastructure Development: Improving public transport and infrastructure for non-motorised vehicles is essential for decongestion.
15. Behavioral Change: Changing the behavior of car users to avoid using cars for every purpose is a key part of the solution.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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